

Virginia Tech Graduate School Orientation 2026

A Detailed Summary and First-Semester Reference Guide

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Figure 1: Virginia Tech campus on the morning of Graduate School orientation, August 21, 2026.

Executive Summary

Virginia Tech's Graduate School orientation presented graduate education as a self-directed process of creating knowledge, building professional relationships, and learning how to use a large university's resources. The central message was practical: Virginia Tech selected each entering student because the institution expects that student to succeed, but graduate students must take responsibility for planning their progress, clarifying expectations, communicating with advisors, and asking for support before a problem grows.

The orientation connected academic progress with personal well-being. Degree milestones, research ethics, mentoring, and professional development formed one part of the program. Health care, counseling, civil rights, conflict support, food and housing assistance, transportation, recreation, and student governance formed the other. These topics support the same objective. A graduate student performs better when academic expectations are explicit, relationships are functional, and basic needs do not consume the attention required for scholarship.

The Graduate Honor System presentation gave generative AI special attention. Virginia Tech does not apply one universal classroom rule to every use of AI. Instructors and research contexts may prohibit, permit, or require different forms of assistance. The student's responsibility is to determine the governing rule before using a tool, document the use, verify every claim and citation, protect restricted information, and remain accountable for the submitted work. The attached course-policy examples reinforce that range of possible rules; they do not replace Virginia Tech policy or an instructor's directions.

This document consolidates the two-hour orientation transcript, twenty photographs of slides and handouts, the attached AI-policy table, and two Virginia Tech guidance pages into one reference. It also translates the information into a first-semester action plan.

Highest-priority actions

1. Confirm that the admission letter, Hokie SPA record, and tuition bill show the correct in-state or out-of-state classification. The orientation warned that Virginia Tech cannot retroactively correct tuition after the applicable deadline.
2. Read the Graduate Catalog and the Computer Science program requirements; map required courses, committee formation, the plan of study, examinations, research milestones, and continuous-enrollment rules.
3. Hold an expectations meeting with the academic advisor. Agree on meeting cadence, communication, feedback timing, research practices, authorship, data management, and near-term deliverables. Send a brief written recap after the meeting.
4. Create an AI-use log for coursework and research. Record the tool and version, date, purpose, prompts, material used, verification performed, and the disclosure or citation included with the work.
5. Review health-insurance status before the August 31, 2026 open-enrollment deadline shown in the orientation handout. Students subject to mandatory coverage rules must enroll or submit an acceptable waiver.
6. Set up practical access now: eduroam, Duo Mobile and backup codes, TimelyCare, the Blacksburg Transit app, and the GLC Weekly email as a recurring source of events and deadlines.

1. Graduate Education at Virginia Tech

1.1 Admission establishes an expectation of success

The opening address noted that Virginia Tech reviewed more than 10,000 graduate applications during the preceding admission cycle. The dean's message was direct: students who received admission offers had demonstrated the experience and ability to succeed. Graduate school may create uncertainty, including imposter syndrome, but admission was a considered institutional decision rather than an accident.

That message establishes a useful starting point for the first semester. Difficulty does not demonstrate that a student does not belong. Graduate work is difficult because it asks students to move beyond receiving established knowledge and begin producing, testing, and communicating new knowledge.

1.2 Land-grant mission and Ut Prosim

Virginia Tech described its land-grant mission through research and discovery, teaching and learning, and service and community engagement. The university's motto, *Ut Prosim* (That I May Serve), connects those functions. Graduate work should contribute to a discipline while also serving communities in Virginia and beyond.

Virginia Tech supports students across several locations: the main campus in Blacksburg; the Roanoke Center; Academic Building One in Alexandria; the Hampton Roads Center in Newport News; the Southwest Center in Abington; additional agricultural research and extension locations; and virtual programs. Students can use the broader institutional network even when Blacksburg is their primary campus.

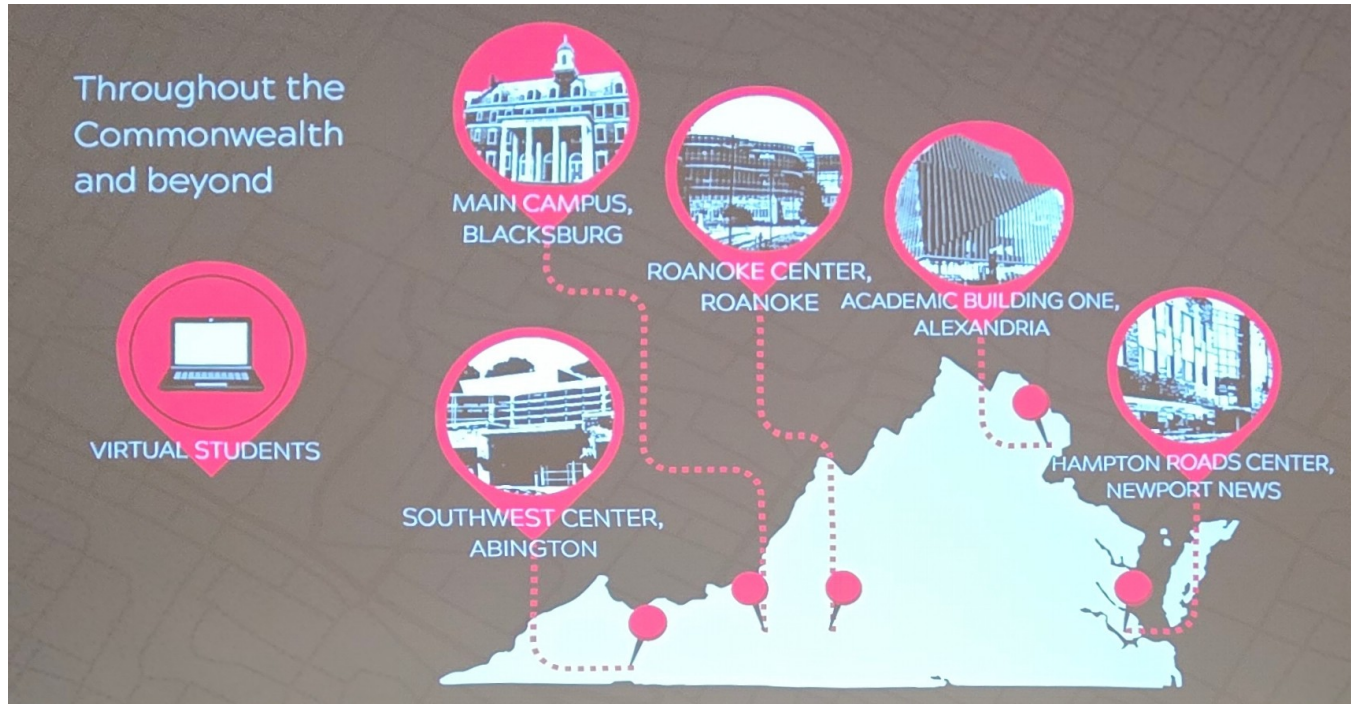


Figure 2: Virginia Tech serves graduate students throughout the Commonwealth and through virtual programs.

1.3 Graduate students become active knowledge creators

The orientation contrasted undergraduate structure with graduate autonomy. Undergraduate programs usually provide a visible route through required courses and assessments. Graduate education leaves more decisions to the student. The student must determine where to find information, identify the next milestone, ask focused questions, and connect daily work to a longer-term goal.

The dean organized that responsibility into four practices:

- **Make a plan.** Assess the current position; define short-, medium-, and long-term outcomes; identify steps; review the plan with advisors and peers; and revise it as conditions change.
- **Stay flexible and adventurous.** Research and careers rarely follow a straight route. New evidence, funding, collaborations, and professional opportunities will change the plan.
- **Understand expectations and communicate.** Students, faculty, programs, and the Graduate School have responsibilities to one another. Students should read the published expectations for graduate education and raise questions early.

- **Use the available resources.** The Graduate School, department, libraries, Student Affairs, wellness services, professional-development programs, and student organizations exist to support progress.

1.4 Build a portfolio of mentors

An academic advisor has a central role, but one person cannot supply every form of support. The orientation recommended a mentoring network that includes people who can provide:

- Subject-matter guidance and substantive feedback.
- Sponsorship, professional opportunities, and introductions.
- Career development beyond the advisor's discipline.
- Intellectual community and accountability.
- Emotional support, psychological safety, and role modeling.

Students should initiate an expectations conversation within the first month. Useful questions include:

- How often should we meet, and should we establish a recurring meeting?
- What work hours, laboratory presence, or response times do you expect?
- How far in advance should I provide drafts for review?
- How will we decide authorship and author order?
- Which data-management, documentation, and research-integrity practices govern the project?
- Which milestones should I reach this semester and this year?

The orientation recommended sending a short email after each substantive meeting. The email should record decisions, assignments, and dates, then invite correction. This habit reduces later disagreement and gives both parties a reliable memory of the relationship.

The student panel added that advisor assignment varies by program. Some students receive an advisor with admission; others approach faculty whose work aligns with their interests. A student may also need to change advisors when the working relationship fails. The panel recommended speaking with current lab members, discussing work style and expectations, and meeting prospective committee members before asking them to serve.

2. Academic Roadmap and Degree Progress

2.1 The roadmap from admission to graduation

The orientation handout assigned responsibilities to the Graduate School, the academic program, the student, or a combination of the program and student. It also identified tasks that can occur before arrival and the final-examination request that must be completed two weeks before the defense.

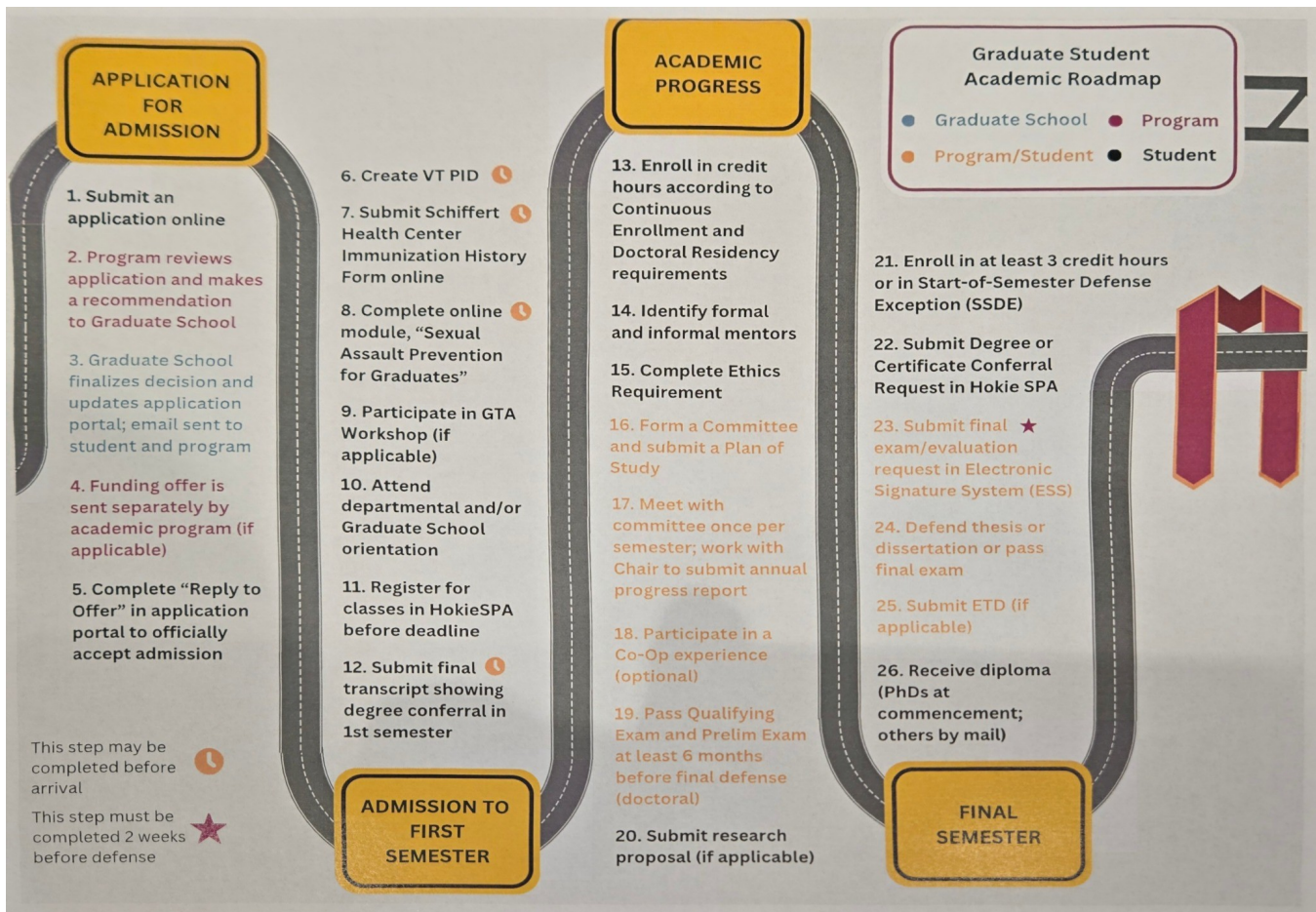


Figure 3: Graduate Student Academic Roadmap distributed at orientation.

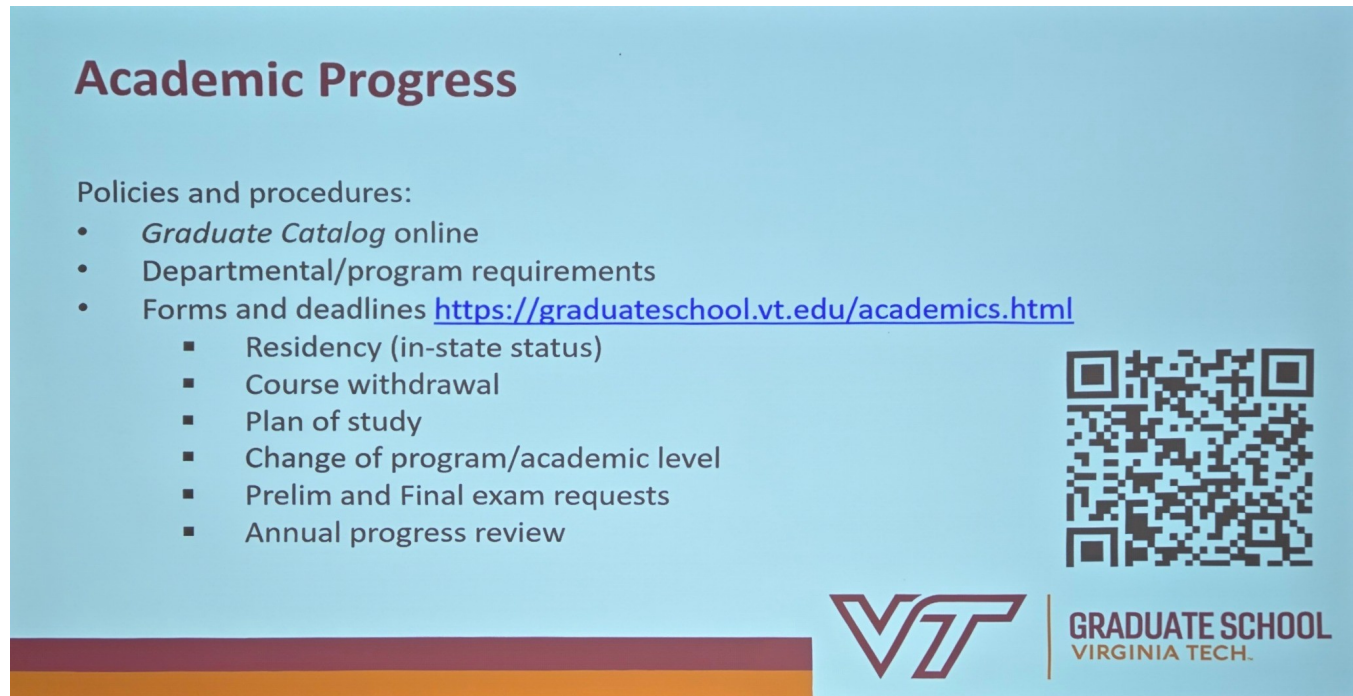
- **Admission.** Submit the application; allow the program to review it and recommend a decision; receive the Graduate School decision; review any separate funding offer; and complete the Reply to Offer in the application portal.
- **Before and during the first semester.** Create the VT PID; submit the Schiffert Health Center immunization history; complete the Sexual Assault Prevention for Graduates module; attend the GTA workshop when applicable; attend program and Graduate School orientations; register in Hokie SPA; and submit a final transcript showing degree conferral during the first semester.
- **Continuing academic progress.** Enroll according to continuous-enrollment and doctoral-residency requirements; identify formal and informal mentors; complete the ethics requirement; form a committee and submit the plan of study; meet with the committee once per semester; and work with the chair on the annual progress report.
- **Research and examinations.** Complete any optional co-op; pass qualifying and preliminary examinations at least six months before the final doctoral defense; and submit the research proposal when the program requires one.
- **Final semester.** Enroll in at least three credit hours or use the Start-of-Semester Defense Exception when eligible; submit the degree or certificate conferral request in Hokie SPA; submit the final examination or evaluation request through the Electronic Signature System at least two weeks before the defense; pass the final examination or defense; submit the electronic thesis or dissertation when applicable; and receive the diploma.

The roadmap is a general framework. Departmental requirements may add courses, examinations, committee rules, publication expectations, or earlier deadlines. The student should therefore maintain one integrated plan that combines the Graduate Catalog, Computer Science requirements, advisor expectations, and research commitments.

2.2 Graduate Catalog, forms, and annual review

The Graduate Catalog functions as the graduate student handbook. The Graduate School's [academics page](#) provides forms and deadlines for residency classification, course withdrawal, plans of study, program or academic-level changes, preliminary and final examinations, and annual progress review.

Each program should conduct an annual student progress evaluation, commonly during the spring. The report informs the Graduate School whether the student is progressing or needs support. A student should treat the annual review as a planning checkpoint rather than wait for the department to initiate it. Maintaining a record of accomplishments, completed requirements, open risks, funding, publications, and next-year goals makes the review useful.



Academic Progress

Policies and procedures:

- *Graduate Catalog* online
- Departmental/program requirements
- Forms and deadlines <https://graduateschool.vt.edu/academics.html>
 - Residency (in-state status)
 - Course withdrawal
 - Plan of study
 - Change of program/academic level
 - Prelim and Final exam requests
 - Annual progress review



 **GRADUATE SCHOOL**
VIRGINIA TECH.

Figure 4: Academic-progress policies, procedures, forms, and deadlines highlighted by the Graduate School.

2.3 Confirm residency classification immediately

The academic-progress presentation emphasized residency because an incorrect classification changes tuition and may be difficult to correct later. A student who expects in-state tuition should verify all three records:

- The first paragraph on the second page of the admission letter.
- Student information in Hokie SPA.
- The tuition bill.

If any record is wrong, the student should contact the Graduate School promptly. The presenter stated that Virginia Tech cannot backdate a correction after the relevant period.

2.4 iThenticate and scholarly attribution

Virginia Tech provides graduate students access to iThenticate. Students may use it for class assignments, manuscripts, conference papers, a thesis, or a dissertation. A thesis or dissertation requires an iThenticate review, but the tool is available

earlier so students can improve attribution practices before the final document. The presenter stated that a student's ordinary uploads and reports remain visible to that student rather than serving as a Graduate School surveillance mechanism.

3. Academic Integrity, the Honor Code, and Generative AI

3.1 Graduate Honor Code scope

The Graduate Honor Code applies to coursework, laboratories, research, teaching, theses and dissertations, extension work, conference material, publications, and routine submissions such as Canvas discussions. The Honor System protects both the credibility of scholarship and the rights of people involved in a concern.

The presentation distinguished an allegation from a finding. A report does not establish that a violation occurred. The Graduate Honor System reviews evidence through a defined process and provides impartial review and due process.

The constitution identifies four broad categories of misconduct:

- **Plagiarism.** Presenting another person's or a tool's words, code, structure, analysis, or ideas as original work without required attribution.
- **Cheating.** Using AI, collaboration, notes, code, or another resource when the governing instructor, assignment, examination, or research protocol does not authorize it.
- **Falsification.** Submitting invented data, methods, citations, quotations, results, or source claims. Confidently written AI output does not excuse a fabricated reference.
- **Academic sabotage.** Interfering with another person's academic work or access to resources. AI does not change the underlying prohibition.

The orientation's most useful rule was **ask before you assume**. Permission in one course, assignment, lab, or publication context does not transfer to another.

3.2 Virginia Tech's course-level AI guidance

Virginia Tech's Technology-enhanced Learning and Online Strategies unit recommends a measured, context-specific approach. Faculty should understand the tools, establish clear course and assignment rules, explain the learning rationale for restrictions, and update those rules as technology and policy change. The guidance advises caution with AI-detection systems because they can produce false positives and false negatives. Virginia Tech does not accept an AI-detector report by itself as evidence in an undergraduate Honor Code case and has not licensed or endorsed a particular detection platform.

For graduate students, the governing lesson is narrower and more actionable. The Graduate Honor System evaluates a possible violation in the context of the guidance the faculty member supplied. Students should request clarification when a policy leaves any ambiguity about brainstorming, editing, coding, data analysis, citation, or direct generation.

Official resource: [Considering Generative AI at Virginia Tech](#), last updated August 17, 2026.

3.3 Responsible AI use in research

The Office of Research and Innovation's guidance applies responsible-AI principles across the research lifecycle. The page addresses conceptualization, literature review, methods, software development and automation, data management and analysis, writing and editing, ethics review, and publication support. It asks researchers to consider transparency, human responsibility, privacy, data protection, bias, reproducibility, sponsor requirements, and disciplinary standards at each stage.

Research use creates obligations beyond a classroom disclosure statement. Before providing material to an AI system, a researcher should check:

- Department and principal-investigator rules.
- Data-use agreements and Virginia Tech data-risk classification.
- IRB or other ethics-review restrictions.
- Sponsor, journal, conference, peer-review, and proposal-review confidentiality rules.
- Intellectual-property, export-control, contractual, and publication obligations when applicable.

Peer review and proposal review require special caution because many journals and sponsors prohibit entering confidential material into an AI service. The researcher remains responsible for methodological validity, source verification, authorship, and every public claim.

Official resource: [Considerations for the Responsible and Ethical Use of AI](#), revised May 19, 2026.

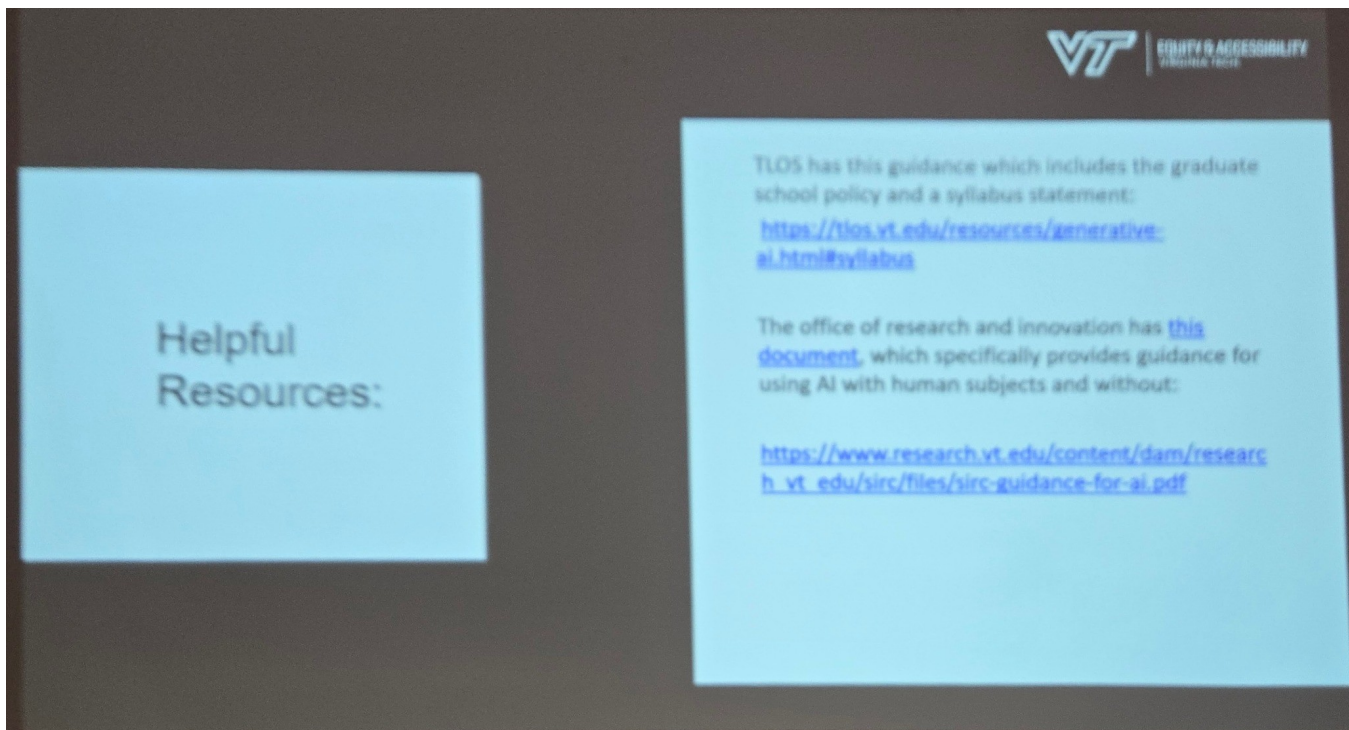


Figure 5: Orientation slide identifying the Virginia Tech TLOS and Office of Research and Innovation resources for generative AI.

3.4 Practical AI-use protocol

The following protocol converts the orientation and official guidance into a repeatable workflow:

- **Determine the governing rule.** Read the syllabus, assignment instructions, lab policy, research protocol, data agreement, sponsor terms, and publication rules that apply to the task.
- **Define the permitted role.** Separate conceptual tutoring, brainstorming, editing, coding, analysis, and content generation. Permission for one function does not authorize the others.
- **Protect information.** Do not submit confidential, sensitive, regulated, proprietary, unpublished, export-controlled, human-subject, or identifiable data unless the governing authority and approved tool permit it.
- **Keep an AI-use record.** Save the tool and model, date, purpose, prompts, relevant outputs, revisions, and the portions that influenced the final work.
- **Verify independently.** Open and read original sources; test code; reproduce calculations; inspect citations; and check for bias, omissions, and outdated information.

- **Write and reason as the responsible author.** Ensure that the submitted analysis reflects the student's understanding. Remove unsupported material rather than polishing it into a stronger-looking claim.
- **Disclose and cite as required.** Use the instructor's, discipline's, sponsor's, or publisher's required format. When no format exists, describe the tool, task, and extent of assistance plainly.
- **Retain evidence.** Keep the interaction log and verification notes with the project's research record so the process can be explained later.

3.5 Comparison of the attached course-policy examples

The attached table contains policies from nine courses or institutional contexts outside Virginia Tech. The examples illustrate a spectrum from required AI use to strong discouragement. They are useful for recognizing policy patterns; they do not govern Virginia Tech coursework.

Course or context	Policy and permitted use	Core duties and limits
CIS 130, Productivity Software, Pierce College	Expected. Course assignments may encourage Copilot, ChatGPT, or image generation.	Verify outputs, inspect original sources, watch for bias, save prompts and outputs, and cite every use. Human judgment remains responsible for the result.
Computer and data science courses, Lyon College	Discouraged. The policy offers little affirmative use and warns that debugging generated code may consume more time than writing it.	Students should protect foundational learning and expect dependency, logic, performance, and style problems in generated code.
Computing and Data Sciences, Boston University	Disclosure required. AI may support ideas, phrasing, evidence mapping, illustrations, translation, and other stated purposes.	Credit every use; attach the relevant exchange; identify the tool; explain how and why it was used; follow assignment-specific prohibitions; and avoid unreflective reuse.
CS 412, Algorithms: Design and Analysis, Habib University	Encouraged. Students may attempt assessments with AI as an explicit classroom experiment.	Report the service, questions, prompts, revisions, and editing decisions, including failed attempts. Correctness and ordinary attribution rules still govern grading.
COSC 426, Natural Language Processing, Colgate University	Conditional. Concept explanations, discussion of a proposed algorithm, prose polishing, and installation debugging.	Some assignments prohibit AI even with citation. Students must ask when uncertain and fact-check subtle technical claims.
CSE 3500, Algorithms and Complexity, University of Connecticut	Acknowledgment required. Idea generation, review, clarification, algorithm selection, and report-writing support.	Include a short statement describing the use. The student owns inaccurate, biased, offensive, or unethical submitted content.
NLP: Self-supervised Models, Johns Hopkins University	Outside-source treatment. Assistance is not categorically forbidden.	Apply academic-honesty and citation rules to AI output; quote when appropriate; do not submit largely generated work; and expect review when submissions are substantially identical.
HCI and Knowledge-Based AI, Georgia Tech	Collaboration model. Students may discuss ideas with AI assistants.	Submitted work must remain the student's own and properly cite outside text. The policy recommends learning through the conversation rather than copying generated material into the assignment.

Course or context	Policy and permitted use	Core duties and limits
Data Structures and Algorithms, Colgate University	Conceptual tutoring only. Fundamental and conceptual questions, reasoning about complexity, and critique of the student's proposed approach.	Students may not request answers, pseudocode, code structure, or generated functions. Prohibited use counts as cheating even when cited; students must verify permitted assistance.

These examples share five durable expectations despite their different permission levels: follow the local rule, document assistance, verify output, protect learning, and accept responsibility for the submitted work.

4. Research, Teaching, and Professional Development

4.1 GRAD 5124 research-skills course

The University Libraries advertised GRAD 5124, Research Skills for Graduate Students, for Fall 2026. The asynchronous, one-credit, fully online course develops graduate research skills. Students select a discipline-specific section in Engineering and Physical Sciences, Life and Health Sciences, or Social and Behavioral Sciences. The handout lists Lisa Russell, lisad5@vt.edu, as the contact.



GRAD 5124
Take your research to the next level!

GRAD 5124 (Research Skills for Graduate Students) is an asynchronous, one-credit, fully-online course offered by the University Libraries in Fall 2026. You'll develop skills that will prepare you for research in graduate school and beyond. Three discipline-specific sections are offered (Engineering & Physical Sciences, Life & Health Sciences, and Social & Behavioral Sciences), so choose your section based on your discipline.

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Questions? Please contact Lisa Russell at lisab5@vt.edu.

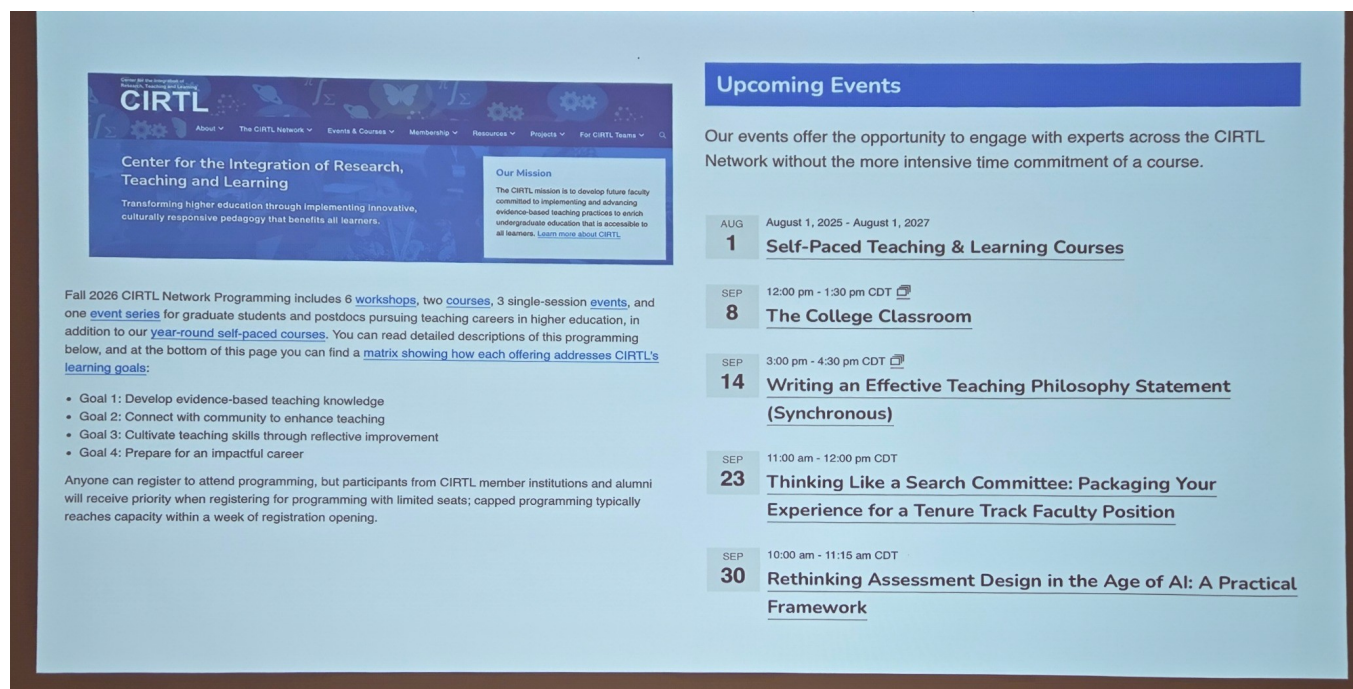
Figure 6: University Libraries handout for GRAD 5124, Research Skills for Graduate Students.

4.2 Graduate School courses and certificates

The orientation described Graduate School courses in diversity and inclusion, ethical and equitable mentoring, preparation for the future professoriate, and contemporary pedagogy. Some courses can contribute to graduate certificates, including diversity and inclusion or future-professoriate credentials. Course numbers and schedules should be confirmed in the current timetable because portions of the transcript were difficult to distinguish.

4.3 Teaching development and CIRTl

Virginia Tech students can use the Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning network. CIRTl's goals include evidence-based teaching knowledge, connection with a teaching community, reflective improvement, and preparation for an academic career. The photographed Fall 2026 schedule included self-paced teaching and learning courses plus events on the college classroom, teaching-philosophy statements, faculty-search preparation, and assessment design in the age of AI.



CIRTl
Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching and Learning

Transforming higher education through implementing innovative, culturally responsive pedagogy that benefits all learners.

Our Mission
The CIRTl mission is to develop future faculty committed to implementing and advancing evidence-based teaching practices to enrich undergraduate education that is accessible to all learners. [Learn more about CIRTl.](#)

Fall 2026 CIRTl Network Programming includes 6 [workshops](#), two [courses](#), 3 single-session [events](#), and one [event series](#) for graduate students and postdocs pursuing teaching careers in higher education, in addition to our [year-round self-paced courses](#). You can read detailed descriptions of this programming below, and at the bottom of this page you can find a [matrix](#) showing how each offering addresses CIRTl's [learning goals](#):

- Goal 1: Develop evidence-based teaching knowledge
- Goal 2: Connect with community to enhance teaching
- Goal 3: Cultivate teaching skills through reflective improvement
- Goal 4: Prepare for an impactful career

Anyone can register to attend programming, but participants from CIRTl member institutions and alumni will receive priority when registering for programming with limited seats; capped programming typically reaches capacity within a week of registration opening.

Upcoming Events

Our events offer the opportunity to engage with experts across the CIRTl Network without the more intensive time commitment of a course.

Month	Date	Event Title
AUG	1	Self-Paced Teaching & Learning Courses
SEP	8	The College Classroom
SEP	14	Writing an Effective Teaching Philosophy Statement (Synchronous)
SEP	23	Thinking Like a Search Committee: Packaging Your Experience for a Tenure Track Faculty Position
SEP	30	Rethinking Assessment Design in the Age of AI: A Practical Framework

Figure 7: CIRTl teaching-development goals and selected Fall 2026 programming.

The Academy for Graduate Pedagogy described in the orientation provides another teaching community. Participation is open to graduate students whether or not they currently serve as graduate teaching assistants. Its focus includes collaboration, inclusion, innovation, and recognition of graduate students' teaching work.

4.4 Writing, fellowship, and community programs

The Graduate School described monthly writing retreats that provide protected writing time, refreshments, and lunch. Students may bring coursework, proposals, preliminary-examination material, manuscripts, or dissertation work. Other programs include fellowship and grant-writing workshops, Lunch with the Dean, Graduate Education Week, GLC Cafe, Mocktail Mondays, and location-specific events for Blacksburg, Roanoke, Northern Virginia, and virtual students.

The GLC Weekly email serves as the continuing index of graduate events, opportunities, and services. The message can be long, but it reduces the need to remember every office and date presented during orientation.

5. Rights, Conflict Support, and Safe Participation

5.1 Civil Rights and Title IX

The Office for Civil Rights Compliance and Prevention Education addresses sex- and gender-based harassment, discrimination based on protected identities, violence prevention, and disability-related compliance. Title IX, Title VI, university nondiscrimination policies, and related federal requirements provide affirmative rights and require Virginia Tech to respond to concerns.

The presentation emphasized three operational points:

- Graduate students often fear retaliation because advisors, laboratories, and programs can create strong power differences. University rules prohibit retaliation, and the office takes reports seriously.
- Contacting the office does not ordinarily cause an immediate investigation against the student's wishes. Staff first listen, explain options, and discuss individually tailored supportive measures. Rare safety or legal circumstances may require action.
- A person can request supportive measures without filing a formal complaint. If an investigation occurs, the process must remain prompt, equitable, and impartial, including notice and an opportunity for the responding person to answer the allegations.

Graduate teaching assistants may become responsible employees with reporting duties under university policy. GTA training should clarify those duties.

5.2 Graduate School ombuds

The Graduate School ombuds offers a confidential, informal, impartial, and independent place to discuss conflict or a difficult situation. The ombuds is not an office of notice and does not decide grievances or conduct investigations. The office can help a student clarify the problem, identify policies and options, prepare for a difficult conversation, find the correct authority, or facilitate communication when requested.

The confidentiality standard has a limited safety exception when a person faces a threat of harm. The presenter stated that the ombuds would address that exception with the student during the conversation rather than make a hidden report afterward.

Students should contact the ombuds while a concern is still manageable. Common reasons include advisor conflict, authorship disputes, unclear program expectations, interpersonal problems, power differences, and uncertainty about a formal process.

5.3 Dean of Students and absence verification

The Dean of Students Office helps students handle complex situations that affect academic work or daily life. Staff can clarify goals, connect resources, and support a student after a crisis. The Absence Verification Program receives appropriate documentation and confirms a qualifying absence to faculty without requiring the student to disclose private medical or family information directly. Not every absence qualifies; the office's published criteria govern the decision.

The office also connects students to emergency funds, housing support, food assistance, first-generation programs, interfaith resources, survivor support, and help understanding student-conduct processes.

5.4 Services for Students with Disabilities

Services for Students with Disabilities supports classroom accommodations, on-campus housing accommodations, academic-relief and suspension appeals, standardized testing, and career development. Students with documented disabilities should

contact the office early enough to complete registration and arrange access before a deadline or acute need. Student accommodations and employee accommodations for GTAs may involve different offices, but SSD can route the request.

6. Health, Counseling, Basic Needs, and Well-Being

6.1 Schiffert Health Center and Cook Counseling Center

Schiffert Health Center provides primary care through physicians, nurse practitioners, and physician assistants. The orientation slide also identified women's health, travel, allergy and immunization services, radiology, laboratory services, and pharmacy support. The student health fee covers many services; some services may carry an additional charge.

Cook Counseling Center provides individual, couples, and group counseling; workshops and support groups; emergency and after-hours support; psychiatry; and medication management. The photographed brochure lists:

- 220 Gilbert Street, Suite 2400, Blacksburg, Virginia 24060.
- Monday through Thursday, 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.; Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.
- 540-231-6557 and ucc.vt.edu.

A first Cook Connect session lasts about 20 to 30 minutes. A clinician listens to the concern, identifies resources, and develops a support plan. The handout states that appointments are usually available within two to three business days. The Graduate School is one of the programs served by an embedded counselor.

Our Services

TREATMENT SERVICES

- Individual and Group Counseling
- Embedded and Residential Counseling
- Psychiatry
- Crisis Consultation

OUTREACH SERVICES

- Workshops
- Presentations
- Support Groups
- Animal Assisted Programs
- Student Leadership



Free Telehealth Services

TIMELYCARE

TimelyCare offers students free, 24/7 access to virtual care services including on-demand mental health support via TalkNow, up to 12 telehealth counseling sessions per academic year, and unlimited health coaching. Register online or download the app to access these services.



Healing Happens Here

Contact Us

- 220 Gilbert St., Suite 2400
Blacksburg, VA 24060
- Mon-Thur: 8 a.m. - 5 p.m.
Fri: 9 a.m. - 5 p.m.
- 540-231-6557
ucc.vt.edu
- @cookcounselingcenter
@vttherapydogs



STUDENT AFFAIRS
COOK COUNSELING CENTER
VIRGINIA TECH

Figure 8: Cook Counseling Center treatment, outreach, telehealth, contact, and operating-hour information.



Cook Connect Sessions

Your first meeting with us will be a Cook Connect Session. In this 20-30 minute appointment, you will meet with a clinician who will listen to your concerns, explore available resources, and create a collaborative, supportive plan tailored to meet your needs. Our goal is to ensure that everyone receives the resources they need to thrive.

Scheduling an Appointment

To schedule a Cook Connect Session, please call us at 540-231-6557. Appointments are typically available within 2-3 business days.



Crisis Support and Resources

If you are experiencing a mental health crisis, we are here to help. During business hours, please visit Cook Counseling Center. If it's after business hours, please call 540-231-6557 to speak with the clinician on call. For 24/7 on demand virtual mental health support, visit timelycare.com/virginiatech.



Confidentiality Policy

We value the privacy of our clients and the confidentiality of personal and health information entrusted to us. In order to protect this privacy, we have policies and procedures to limit disclosures of personal information to those minimally necessary for the medical care of the client, those for which the client has given permission, and/or those required by law or public safety.

Embedded Counselors

RESIDENTIAL WELL-BEING

Residential Well-being embedded counselors are dedicated to serving Virginia Tech's residential student population. Their mission is to elevate students' mental, emotional, and social well-being by reducing barriers to accessing mental health services. They offer scheduled appointments and drop-in/crisis services.

Location: East Eggleston Hall, Suite 107
Hours: Mon. - Thur. 2:00 p.m. - 10:00 p.m.
Fri. 1:00 p.m. - 4:00 p.m.

COLLEGES OR PROGRAMS

We also have embedded counselors in the following locations:

- College of Science
- Pamplin College of Business
- College of Engineering
- College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences
- The Athletic Department
- Corps of Cadets
- The Graduate School
- School of Veterinary Medicine
- Roanoke Campus
- Greater DC Metro Campus

If you would like to be scheduled with an embedded counselor in your academic college or program, please request this when you call for an appointment.

Figure 9: Cook Connect, crisis support, confidentiality, and embedded-counselor information.



Figure 10: Student support services highlighted during orientation.

6.2 TimelyCare

Virginia Tech students receive free, 24-hour virtual access through TimelyCare. The orientation materials listed:

- On-demand mental-health support through TalkNow.
- Up to 12 virtual counseling appointments per academic year.
- Yoga and meditation videos.
- Health-coaching sessions.

Students can register through timelycare.com/viriniatech. For a mental-health crisis during Cook Counseling business hours, the brochure directs students to Cook; after hours, students may call Cook's number to reach an on-call clinician or use TimelyCare for 24-hour virtual support.

TIMELYCARE

Students have **free, 24/7 access to virtual care services** with TimelyCare – the virtual health and well-being platform.

Once registered, you'll get immediate access to:

- 24/7 Mental Health Support via TalkNow
- 12 Virtual Counseling Appointments per year
- Yoga + Meditation videos
- Health Coaching Sessions

Don't wait. Download the app today for free mental health support – anytime, anywhere.

**VT STUDENT AFFAIRS
VIRGINIA TECH**

SCAN HERE

Figure 11: TimelyCare services available to Virginia Tech students.

6.3 Hokie Wellness and recovery support

Hokie Wellness offers classes, workshops, and individual consultations. Topics in the handout included alcohol and other drugs, digital well-being, financial wellness, mental health, sleep, body image, budgeting, credit, student loans, and debt management. Individual consultations address financial wellness or substance use. The office is located at 142 McComas Hall, 895 Washington Street SW, Blacksburg, with the phone number 540-231-2233 and website hokiewellness.vt.edu.

Additional initiatives include digital well-being challenges, mental-health worksheets, Party Positive harm-reduction programming, No Hokie Left Behind, and employee-wellness programs that welcome graduate students. The Virginia Tech Recovery Community supports students in recovery through one-on-one help, recovery meetings, events, trips, and meeting space. The handout lists rc@vt.edu for individual recovery support.

CLASSES AND WORKSHOPS

Hokie Wellness offers many different classes and workshops that are designed to help students make informed decisions around a variety of topics. Our classes and workshops are customizable and available to student organizations and groups. Scan the QR code to request a class or workshop.



ALCOHOL AND OTHER DRUGS

REVIVE! Training | Party Positive (alcohol) | Higher Education (cannabis) | Alcohol and Belonging

DIGITAL WELL-BEING

Intro to Digital Well-being | Digital Dependence | The Power of Fun | Body Image | Sleep

FINANCIAL WELLNESS

Budgeting Basics | Credit | Students Loans & Debt Management | Sports Betting | Finances After Graduation | Eating Well on a Budget

MENTAL HEALTH

Self-Care | Growth Mindset | Mindful Journaling | Helping Those in Distress | Connecting and Communicating | Alcohol and Belonging | Community Resilience Model | Rock Painting | Glitter Jars | Affirmation Bracelets

1-ON-1 CONSULTATIONS

All Virginia Tech students can receive 1-on-1 consultations on the following topics to live healthy lives:

Financial Wellness (Budget, Credit, Loans, or Debt Management)
Substance Use (Alcohol, Cannabis, Tobacco, Or Other)

WHERE TO FIND US

142 McComas Hall
885 Washington St. SW
Blacksburg, VA 24061
(540) 231-2233

Follow us! @hokiewellness



Scan here to check us out
online, or visit
hokiewellness.vt.edu



GUIDE TO GRAD STUDENT SERVICES

OUR MISSION

Hokie Wellness strives to educate and empower every Hokie to take an active and engaging day-to-day approach to their wellness in order to enjoy a long, healthful, and purpose-filled life.



HOKIE WELLNESS
VIRGINIA TECH



Figure 12: Hokie Wellness graduate-student classes, consultations, contact information, and mission.




INITIATIVES

NO HOKIE LEFT BEHIND
Go with friends. Stay with friends. Leave with friends. That is what it means to be a Hokie. As you explore campus and beyond, remember to take care of each other and stick together.

BIRD BUCKS
Bird Bucks are our office currency: fake money students can use to buy real prizes and swag. Find out where we will be next on Gobblerconnect or our Instagram!






OUTREACH

Hokie Wellness actively engages the Virginia Tech community on a variety of health topics. Our programs include:

DIGITAL WELL-BEING

Digital Well-being initiatives teach students how to thrive with devices in ways that foster connection, learning, and meaningful college experiences. Students can learn about and practice digital well-being by participating in our weekly challenges, tabling throughout campus, and by using the phone boxes, with conversation cards, in various campus locations.



MENTAL HEALTH WORKSHEETS

Mental health worksheets are a way to learn skills to support your mental and emotional well-being on your own time. These worksheets are designed to help you learn skills such as journaling, self-care, affirmations and more by prompting you to think about your current life and how you can implement new skills to improve your well-being.



PARTY POSITIVE

Party Positive is a campus-wide harm reduction campaign that includes in-person, student-facilitated outreach. It maximizes positive social outcomes and seeks to reduce or eliminate negative outcomes associated with alcohol. Be on the lookout for tabling and other Party Positive activities around campus.


EMPLOYEE WELLNESS

As graduate students, you are welcome to join any of the employee wellness programs that interest you. The best way to keep track of opportunities is to join their listserv.




VT RECOVERY COMMUNITY

The Virginia Tech Recovery Community works to ensure that students do not have to choose between their recovery and their education. We support students inside and outside the classroom, organize events and trips, and provide space for recovery meetings. Anyone is welcome, anytime.

ONE-ON-ONE RECOVERY SUPPORT

Email rc@vt.edu to schedule

MEETINGS

WEEKLY ALL RECOVERY MEETING: a support-group-style recovery meeting for ALL individuals who identify as being in recovery from substance use or other behaviors on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Thursdays. Scan the QR code for times and locations.





Scan to learn more or register for an upcoming class or workshop!

Figure 13: Hokie Wellness outreach initiatives, employee wellness, and the Virginia Tech Recovery Community.

6.4 Basic needs

The Dean of Students presentation identified three forms of food support through The Market: a time-limited enrolled program with weekly groceries, open hours that students can use with a Hokie Passport, and pocket pantries placed around campus. The office also helps students facing an unexpected financial emergency or housing insecurity. Graduate students use these services in substantial numbers; seeking support protects academic progress rather than reflecting a failure to manage graduate school.

6.5 Student medical insurance

The 2026-2027 handout lists open enrollment from July 1 through August 31 and a policy year of August 1, 2026 through July 31, 2027. Students with F-1 or J-1 visas, students in the Virginia-Maryland College of Veterinary Medicine, and Virginia Tech Carilion School of Medicine students must maintain qualifying coverage. The handout states that a student who must enroll and misses the deadline will be automatically enrolled in the annual Aetna plan.

Student Health Insurance

Open Enrollment Dates:
July 1st – August 31st



Students with F-1 or J-1 Visas, VET MED, and VTCSOM are **REQUIRED** to have medical insurance either through Virginia Tech's Student Medical Insurance or a comparable insurance plan that meets university requirements. If you do not meet the deadline, you will automatically be enrolled in the Aetna Student Health Insurance for the annual term.

Students looking for more information on Insurance Requirements or looking to submit a waiver, please visit our website.

VT Aetna Plan
8/1/26 - 7/31/27 Policy Year

Cost
(annual)

Student Only:	\$3,993
Student +1:	\$7,986
Student +2:	\$11,979
Student +3:	\$15,972

Cost For Annual GAs

Student only:	\$479.22
Student +1:	\$4,472.22
Student +2:	\$8,465.22
Student +3:	\$12,458.22

Coverage Includes:

- Schiffert Services 100% covered
- \$15 eye exams
- Glasses reimbursement
- Maternity
- Mental Health
- Prescription coverage
- Chiropractic

Optional Dental Plan

Annual cost is \$476

Student Medical Insurance
540-231-6226
smi@vt.edu
Student Services Building, Suite 110
<https://risk.vt.edu/smi.html>



Figure 14: Student medical-insurance enrollment dates, annual costs, graduate-assistant amounts, and coverage information.

Coverage level	Annual VT Aetna plan	Annual graduate-assistant amount shown on handout
Student only	\$3,993.00	\$479.22
Student plus one	\$7,986.00	\$4,472.22

Coverage level	Annual VT Aetna plan	Annual graduate-assistant amount shown on handout
Student plus two	\$11,979.00	\$8,465.22
Student plus three	\$15,972.00	\$12,458.22

The handout also lists an optional dental plan at \$476 annually. Medical-plan features shown include 100 percent coverage for Schiffert services, \$15 eye examinations, reimbursement for glasses, maternity care, mental-health care, prescriptions, and chiropractic care. Students should verify eligibility, dependent definitions, waiver standards, payroll treatment, and current benefits with Student Medical Insurance at 540-231-6226, smi@vt.edu, or risk.vt.edu/smi.html.

7. Campus Access, Transportation, and Daily Logistics

7.1 Wireless access and Duo

The orientation handout directs students to join the **eduroam** wireless network using the full VT email address and a network password. Students can view or generate that password through onecampus.vt.edu by searching for Manage Accounts and selecting Network Password under Network Access.

Duo Mobile provides two-factor authentication. Students should also generate a set of one-time backup codes through Manage Accounts and store them securely. Virginia Tech 4Help is available at 4help.vt.edu or 540-231-4357.

Online: 4help.vt.edu
Phone: 1-(540)-2314357

4Help

Welcome!

Internet

Connecting to Wireless:

- Wireless network: eduroam
- Username: VT email (username@vt.edu)
- Password: Network Password

Find your network password:

- Go to onecampus.vt.edu and search for "Manage Accounts"
- Sign in with your VT Username and password/passphrase
- Under "Network Access" click "Network Password" to view your network password/generate a new one

Duo Mobile

Duo Mobile is used for 2-Factor at Virginia Tech. You can download the app from the google play store or the (apple) app store. You can also print 10 passcodes at a time from your VT account:

Printing one-time use passcodes:

- Go to onecampus.vt.edu and search for "Manage Accounts"
- Sign in with your VT Username and password/passphrase
- Under "2-Factor Account" click "Print Passcodes"
- Click "Generate" to print your backup codes

For more on Duo Security: it.vt.edu/projects/2Factor

Figure 15: Virginia Tech eduroam, network-password, Duo Mobile, backup-code, and 4Help instructions.

7.2 Blacksburg Transit

Blacksburg Transit is fare-free. The orientation handouts offered three ways to obtain estimated arrival times:

- Use the Blacksburg Transit mobile app and filter for the stop.
- Text the stop number to 540-443-7433.
- Use ridebt.org or bt4uclassic.org.

Students should reach the stop at least five minutes before the estimated arrival and plan to catch a bus about 30 minutes before class. Riders should ask the driver when unsure about a route, pull the yellow cord after passing the stop before their destination, and exit through the rear door. Football game-day traffic disrupts schedules; the handout recommends waiting at the stop and checking ridebt.org/football.

Where's the bus?

TIPS TO GET BUS STOP TIMES

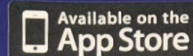
The hardest part of riding the bus is knowing when to catch it. Here are our best tools for estimated stop times.

ALWAYS get to a stop 5 minutes early.

WE ARE FARE FREE!

BT APP

Download the **Blacksburg Transit App**. Tip: Filter info for your stop.



TEXTING

Text your stop # to 540-443-7433 for the next arrival times.

WEBSITE

Two Websites:

- ridebt.org - All BT info
- bt4uclassic.org - basic info

WHAT ABOUT GAME DAYS?

With thousands of Hokie fans and their cars flooding Blacksburg, it's impossible to keep routes on schedule. The best option? Wait at the bus stop. We promise a bus will be there soon.

More info at ridebt.org/football

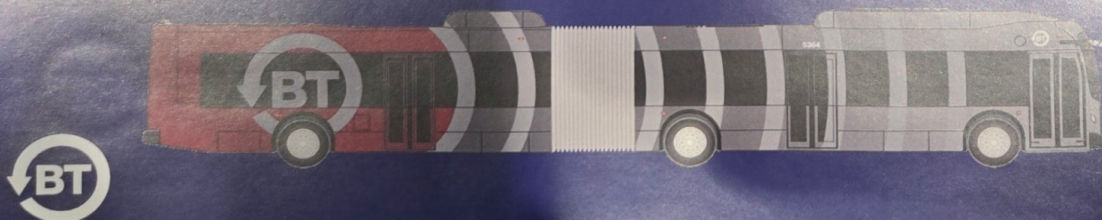


Figure 16: Blacksburg Transit arrival-time tools and fare-free service.

How do I ride the bus?

1.) Find your stop/route



Use rideBT.org or the Blacksburg Transit App to find route / stop info.

2.) Catch the bus 30 mins before class



Get to your stop at least 5 mins before bus arrival time.

3.) Get on the bus



Not sure if it's the right bus? **Ask the driver!** They're happy to help.

4.) Pull the cord to stop the bus



Pull the yellow cord after you pass the stop before yours.

5.) Exit the bus thru the rear door



Don't forget your bike!



Questions? We're here to help!

 @RideBT

 @Ride_BT

 RideBT

 ridebt@blacksburg.gov

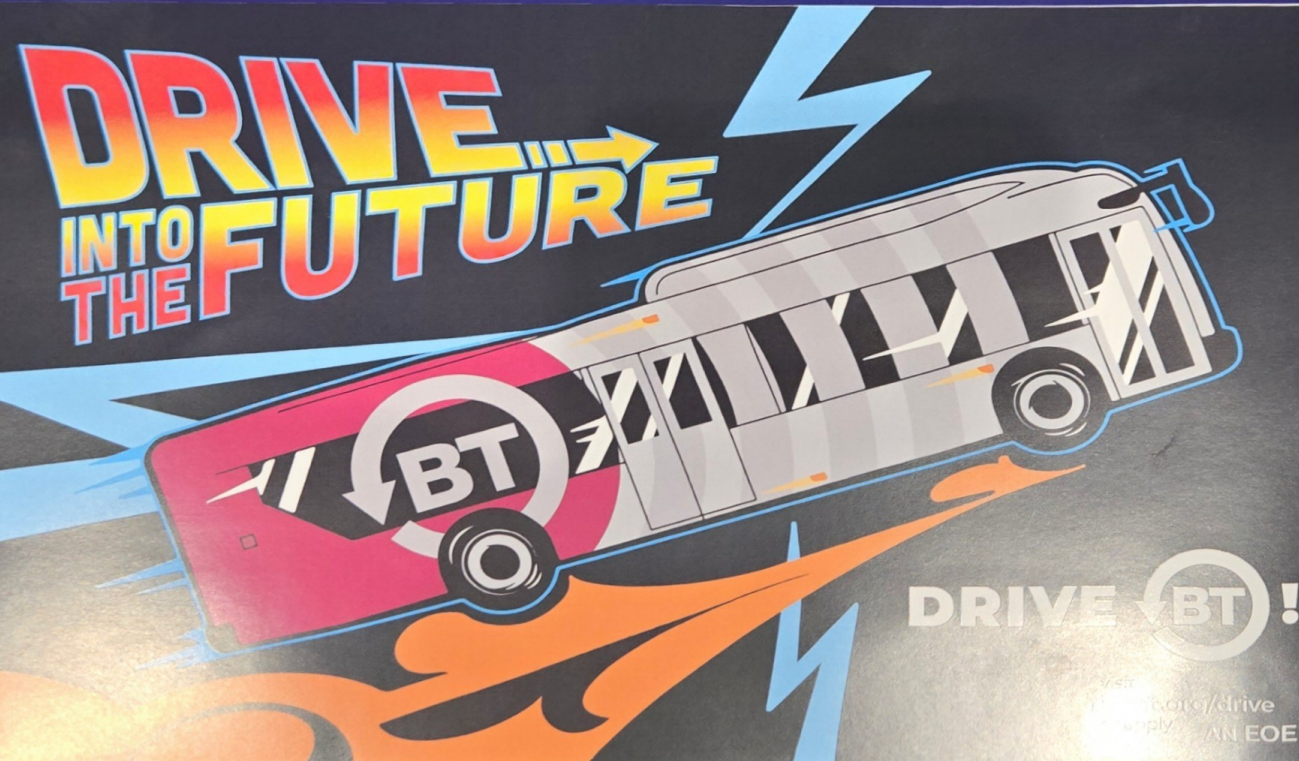


Figure 17: Blacksburg Transit riding instructions and rider-support contact channels.

7.3 Graduate Life Center

The Graduate Life Center is a dedicated graduate-student space. It includes the Graduate School offices and welcome area, reservable rooms for study groups and defenses, a reading room, a wellness room, event space, GLC Cafe programming, and embedded counseling. Students can use the building as a regular academic and community base rather than visit only for administrative transactions.



Figure 18: Campus plaza and Graduate Life Center area photographed before orientation.

8. Community, Governance, and Recreation

8.1 Graduate and Professional Student Senate

The Graduate and Professional Student Senate represents graduate and professional students in Virginia Tech shared governance. Open senate meetings provide a route to raise program and university concerns. GPSS also supports conference travel and research development, hosts a research symposium, operates a cap-and-gown loan program, organizes community events, and provides funding for graduate student organizations through its budget board. Students may attend meetings, serve as senators, or request organizational support. The orientation listed gpss@vt.edu as a contact.

The graduate and professional student representative to the Board of Visitors provides another route for concerns. The representative attends Board meetings, reports graduate issues, and connects students with university governance.

8.2 Finding community

The student panel recommended GobblerConnect for finding organizations, including graduate-only groups. Gobblerfest, departmental graduate organizations, cultural and community centers, Mocktail Mondays, farmers markets, and GLC events offer lower-pressure ways to meet people outside the laboratory or cohort.

Panelists described networking as a practice rather than a personality trait. Useful approaches include attending with a friend, placing an event on the calendar before anxiety creates an excuse, cold-emailing a researcher with a specific reason to meet, and joining an organization whose work supplies a natural conversation topic.

For imposter syndrome, panelists recommended avoiding comparisons between people at different stages and with different constraints. They stressed sleep, exercise, counseling when useful, supportive relationships, and activities that provide identity outside the degree program. One panelist noted that admission itself provides evidence that the student earned a place in the program.

8.3 Recreation and intramural sports

War Memorial Hall's orientation handout listed gymnasium hours of 5:00 a.m. to 11:00 p.m. Monday through Friday and 10:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. on weekends. Pool hours were 7:00 a.m. to 3:30 p.m. and 5:00 p.m. to 7:00 p.m. Monday through Friday, with weekend closure shown. Students should verify current hours at recsports.vt.edu/hours.



The poster features a background image of War Memorial Hall. The text is arranged in a clear, hierarchical manner. The top section is for the Gymnasium, followed by the Pool section. Each section has two columns for different days of the week. The text is primarily in orange and maroon colors, matching the Virginia Tech branding.

WAR MEMORIAL HALL

GYMNASIUM HOURS

MON - FRI	SAT - SUN
5 AM - 11 PM	10 AM - 10 PM

POOL HOURS

MON - FRI	SAT - SUN
7 AM - 3:30 PM 5 PM - 7 PM	CLOSED

VISIT: RECSPORTS.VT.EDU /HOURS
FOR MORE DETAILS ON THE BUILDING HOURS

VT RECREATIONAL SPORTS
VIRGINIA TECH

Figure 19: War Memorial Hall gymnasium and pool hours distributed at orientation.

The 2026-2027 intramural schedule included kickball, flag football, volleyball, lacrosse, basketball, cornhole, soccer, racquet sports, water polo, softball, ultimate Frisbee, pickleball, tennis, and other team or tournament formats. The first fall registration window shown was August 24 through September 3, with play beginning September 6. The handout directs students to purchase a \$25 intramural membership and register at recsports.vt.edu/intramurals.

VIRGINIA TECH RECREATIONAL SPORTS

INTRAMURAL

SPORTS

2026-2027

SCHEDULE



FALL TEAM SPORTS	REGISTRATION	DATES OF PLAY
8v8 Kickball	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
7v7 Flag Football	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
4v4 Sand Volleyball	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
4v4 Speed Lacrosse	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
3v3 Basketball	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
2v2 Cornhole	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
2v2 Spikeball	8/24-9/3	9/6-10/15
3v3 Goalball Tournament	8/24-9/3	9/6-9/20
2v2 Golf Tournament	8/31-9/10	9/18
6v6 Women's Volleyball Tournament	9/14-9/24	9/28-10/6
9v9 Soccer	10/12-10/22	10/25-12/10
6v6 Volleyball	10/12-10/22	10/25-12/10
3v3 Battleship	10/12-10/22	10/25-12/10
2v2 Kan Jam Tournament	10/12-10/22	10/25-11/1
4v4 Dodgeball Tournament	10/19-10/29	11/2-11/17
2v2 Racquetball Tournament	10/19-10/29	11/4-11/18
6v6 Sitting Volleyball Tournament	11/9-11/19	12/1-12/8

SPRING TEAM SPORTS	REGISTRATION	DATES OF PLAY
7v7 Innertube Water Polo	1/18-1/28	1/31-3/18
5v5 Basketball	1/18-1/28	1/31-3/18
4v4 Wallyball	1/18-1/28	1/31-3/18
2v2 Table Tennis	1/18-1/28	1/31-3/18
2v2 Badminton Tournament	1/18-1/28	1/31-2/28
4v4 Floor Hockey Tournament	2/1-2/11	2/16-3/2
10v10 Softball	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
7v7 Ultimate Frisbee	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
6v6 Handball	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
4v4 Indoor Soccer	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
2v2 Pickleball	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
2v2 Tennis	3/15-3/25	3/29-5/6
2v2 Disc Golf Tournament	3/22-4/1	4/9
2v2 Bocce Ball Tournament	3/29-4/8	4/11-4/25



Scan or visit
recsports.vt.edu/intramurals to:

1. Purchase your \$25 membership to play any and all sports
2. View and sign up for sports and activities

Figure 20: Virginia Tech Recreational Sports 2026-2027 intramural schedule and registration information.

Venture Out organizes hiking, stargazing, caving, horseback riding, canoeing, and other excursions, commonly including equipment and transportation. These programs provide a practical route to exercise and community without requiring a student to organize the trip.

9. A First-Semester Operating Plan

Before classes and during the first week

- Confirm enrollment, tuition classification, billing, immunization records, the final transcript, and required online modules.
- Review each syllabus for AI, collaboration, reuse, citation, attendance, and late-work rules.
- Configure eduroam, Duo backup codes, Hokie SPA access, email, TimelyCare, and the BT app.
- Check student medical insurance enrollment or waiver status before August 31.
- Add GLC Weekly and program communications to a weekly review routine.

During the first month

- Meet the advisor and record agreed expectations.
- Draft a degree roadmap that joins coursework, the plan of study, committee formation, examinations, research deliverables, funding, and publication goals.
- Identify at least three people outside the primary-advisor relationship who can provide complementary mentoring.
- Establish a recurring weekly planning period and a monthly progress review.
- Decide how AI interactions, source verification, code testing, and disclosures will be logged for each course and research project.
- Visit the Graduate Life Center and identify the locations of the Graduate School offices, reservable rooms, embedded counselor, and wellness space.

During the first semester

- Submit the final transcript showing degree conferral if it remains outstanding.
- Review the program's ethics requirement and determine when it must be completed.
- Begin the plan of study and committee discussion early enough to avoid a procedural delay.
- Use iThenticate on a draft to understand similarity reports before a thesis, dissertation, or publication deadline.
- Evaluate GRAD 5124, CIRTLL programming, Graduate School courses, writing retreats, and fellowship workshops against current professional goals.
- Join one graduate organization, governance activity, or recurring community program.
- Create a brief accomplishments and risks record for the annual progress review.

10. Resource Directory

Need	Primary resource	Contact or link
Graduate requirements, forms, and deadlines	Graduate School Academic Progress	graduateschool.vt.edu/academics.html
Graduate academic-integrity questions	Graduate Honor System	540-231-9564; ghs@vt.edu
Course-level generative-AI guidance	TLOS	Considering Generative AI at Virginia Tech
AI in research	Scholarly Integrity and Research Compliance	Responsible and Ethical Use of AI

Need	Primary resource	Contact or link
Health care	Schiffert Health Center	healthcenter.vt.edu
Counseling and crisis consultation	Cook Counseling Center	540-231-6557; ucc.vt.edu
24-hour virtual mental-health support	TimelyCare	timelycare.com/virginiatech
Student accommodations	Services for Students with Disabilities	ssd.vt.edu
Wellness education and consultations	Hokie Wellness	540-231-2233; hokiewellness.vt.edu
Student medical insurance	Student Medical Insurance	540-231-6226; smi@vt.edu; risk.vt.edu/smi.html
Graduate governance and organizations	GPSS	gpss@vt.edu
Bus routes and arrivals	Blacksburg Transit	ridebt.org ; text stop number to 540-443-7433
Recreation	Recreational Sports	recsports.vt.edu
Account, network, and Duo support	4Help	540-231-4357; 4help.vt.edu

Conclusion

The orientation framed graduate school as a relationship between individual agency and institutional support. The student must plan the degree, clarify rules, sustain communication, and take responsibility for scholarly work. Virginia Tech must provide fair processes, capable advising, academic infrastructure, health and wellness resources, and routes for resolving problems. Success depends on using both sides of that relationship.

For a Computer Science doctoral student working in AI and human-computer interaction, the Honor Code discussion has immediate relevance. AI can support research and learning, but every use sits inside a specific course, data, research, sponsor, and publication context. A disciplined record of permission, prompts, verification, and disclosure protects academic integrity while allowing productive experimentation.

The most effective first-semester strategy is straightforward: build the roadmap, establish the advisor relationship, protect time and health, document research practices, and use the Graduate School's support network before a small uncertainty becomes a large problem.

Appendix A. Photograph Source Index

The report uses all twenty orientation photographs as figures in the main text. The index below identifies each photograph and the information it contributes to the report.

File	Subject	Information incorporated into this report
20260821_085240.jpg	Campus plaza and Graduate Life Center area	Orientation setting and graduate-campus context.
20260821	Virginia Tech campus	Opening figure and visual record of orientation day.

File	Subject	Information incorporated into this report
_085250.jpg	lawn	
20260821_090642.jpg	Virginia Tech locations	Blacksburg, Roanoke, Alexandria, Newport News, Abingdon, and virtual-program reach.
20260821_091306.jpg	Hokie Wellness graduate services	Workshops, individual consultations, location, phone number, and wellness topics.
20260821_091352.jpg	Wireless and Duo guide	eduroam, Network Password, Manage Accounts, Duo Mobile, backup codes, and 4Help.
20260821_091432.jpg	Cook Counseling brochure	Treatment and outreach services, TimelyCare summary, location, hours, phone, and web address.
20260821_091446.jpg	Cook Connect and embedded counselors	Initial consultation, appointment timing, crisis support, confidentiality, and Graduate School embedded counseling.
20260821_091614.jpg	Graduate Student Academic Roadmap	Admission, first-semester, progress, examination, defense, and conferral milestones.
20260821_092023.jpg	Blacksburg Transit arrival information	Fare-free service, mobile app, text service, websites, early arrival, and game-day guidance.
20260821_092035.jpg	Riding the bus and BT employment	Route selection, boarding, stop request, rear-door exit, rider assistance, and transit contact channels.
20260821_092207.jpg	GRAD 5124	Course format, credit value, disciplinary sections, semester, and contact.
20260821_092302.jpg	Hokie Wellness outreach and recovery	Digital well-being, mental-health worksheets, Party Positive, employee wellness, recovery community, and meetings.
20260821_092557.jpg	CIRTL programming	Teaching-development goals, self-paced courses, and Fall 2026 event topics.
20260821_093207.jpg	Student medical insurance	Enrollment period, mandatory populations, costs, graduate-assistant amounts, benefits, dental option, and contact.
20260821_093247.jpg	War Memorial Hall hours	Gymnasium and pool hours plus the current-hours website.
20260821_093318.jpg	Intramural sports schedule	2026-2027 sports, registration windows, dates of play, membership amount, and registration site.
20260821_093412.jpg	Student Affairs support services	SSD, Schiffert Health Center, Cook Counseling Center, and service websites.
20260821_093820.jpg	TimelyCare	TalkNow, annual counseling appointments, wellness videos, health coaching, and 24-hour access.

File	Subject	Information incorporated into this report
pg		
20260821_100601.jpg	Helpful AI resources	TLOS generative-AI guidance and SIRC research-use guidance.
20260821_101038.jpg	Academic progress	Graduate Catalog, program requirements, forms, residency, withdrawal, plan of study, exams, and annual review.

References and Source Notes

- Virginia Tech Graduate School. *Graduate School Student Orientation*. Presentation and student panel, Blacksburg, Virginia, August 21, 2026. Summary based on the attached transcript.
- Conklin, Nathan. *Virginia Tech Graduate School Orientation Photographs*. Personal photograph collection, August 21, 2026. Twenty images of campus, presentation slides, and handouts supplied with this report.
- Virginia Tech Technology-enhanced Learning and Online Strategies. [Considering Generative AI at Virginia Tech](#). Last updated August 17, 2026. Accessed August 23, 2026.
- Virginia Tech Office of Research and Innovation. [Considerations for the Responsible and Ethical Use of AI](#). Revised May 19, 2026. Accessed August 23, 2026.
- *Course AI Policy Examples*. Attached Markdown table supplied with this report. The table collects nine policies from computing courses and programs at Pierce College, Lyon College, Boston University, Habib University, Colgate University, the University of Connecticut, Johns Hopkins University, and Georgia Tech.

Date-sensitive information

Insurance prices, enrollment deadlines, facility hours, event dates, course availability, transit practices, and intramural schedules reproduce information distributed or displayed at the August 21, 2026 orientation. Confirm current details with the responsible Virginia Tech office before making a financial, registration, travel, or scheduling decision.